Rose through the gunsights they'd spent those years in Germany assembling. Rose crossed Unter den Linden.

Léa stood. She couldn't speak. She could only stare at Rose's gray hair, the lines about her eyes and mouth, her limp—what had happened to her? In Léa's imagination, Rose had never changed. She'd always been the twenty-one-year-old sister she'd last seen getting out of the car. Why hadn't she realized that she too would have aged, just like Léa? She stepped closer.

Léa didn't know what to say. It was Rose, but it wasn't her, either.

"I'm sorry," Rose started, "please forgive me."

Léa's fears crumbled to dust. The love she'd always had for her sister, the bond that had endured the twists and turns that took their lives down different paths, welled up in her chest. It hadn't died and withered. She took one last step, arms outstretched and held her.

"We must forgive one another." Léa sobbed and buried her head on Rose's shoulder, and the sisters stood like that in the cold under the linden tree holding on to one another for a long while as the weight of more than four decades finally lifted.

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